Meltwater

Reduce Cognitive Load in Newsletter

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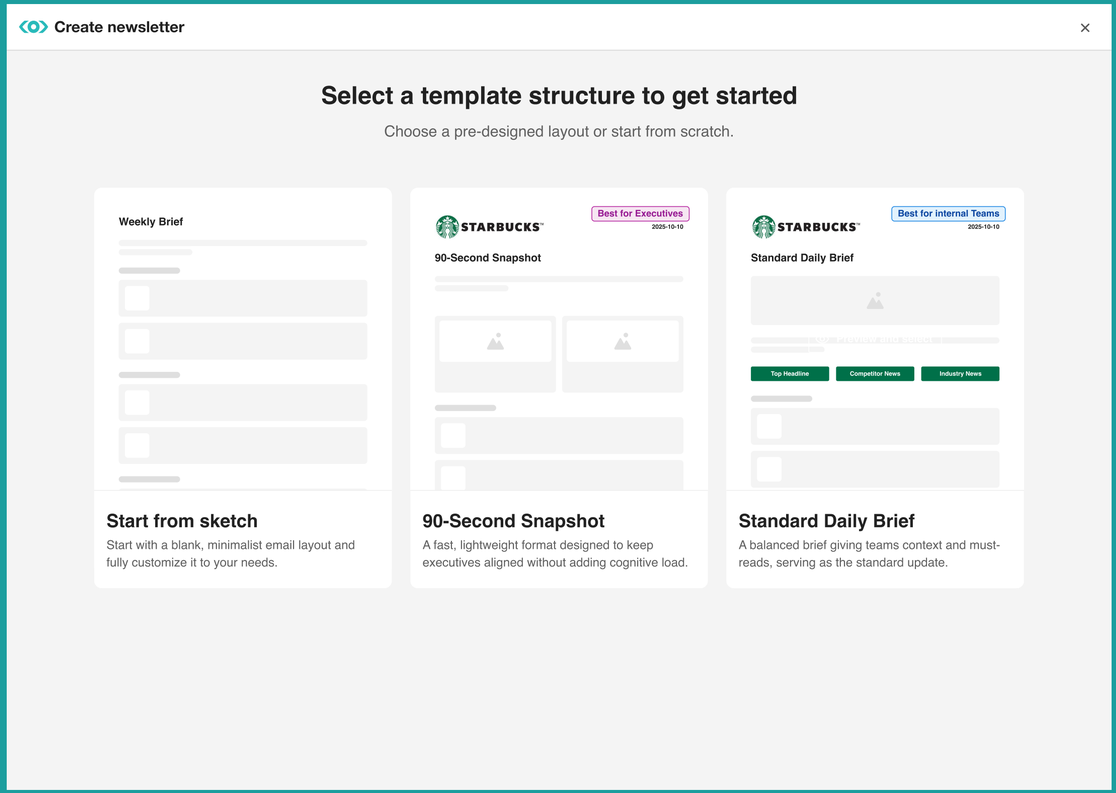

NEWSLETTER

AGENDA

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Content

I AM

A NEW PR PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBLE FOR SENDING ROUTINE MEDIA MONITORING UPDATES

I'M TRYING TO

QUICKLY CREATE POLISHED, HIGH-QUALITY UPDATES THAT HIGHLIGHT THE MOST IMPORTANT STORIES WHILE REFLECTING MY ORGANIZATION'S UNIQUE PRIORITIES & BRANDING

BUT

EXISTING TEMPLATE TOOLS ARE EITHER TOO RIGID OR TOO TIME-CONSUMING TO CUSTOMIZE

BECAUSE

THERE'S NO SATISFACTORY WAY TO CREATE A TEMPLATE SO I CAN FOCUS ON CONTENT CURATION AND WITHOUT SPENDING TOO MUCH TIME ON THE TEMPLATE DESIGN

WHICH MAKES ME FEEL

FRUSTRATED, INEFFICIENT, OVERWHELMED

Problem Statement

How might we enable PR professionals to quickly create/access branded, polished templates so they can focus more on content curation instead of spending excessive time on design?

Understand the problem

Manual Newsletter

Create a New Manual Newsletter

- Create a branded template
- Select articles manually

→

Create a New Draft

- Add a distribution to an existing manual newsletter.
- Select articles manually

Automated Newsletter

Create a New Automated Newsletter

- Create a branded template
- Articles are automatically selected based on your settings
- Sent on a custom recurring schedule (daily, weekly, etc.)

Understand the problem

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Journey Map

Mental Model / Empathy Map

SARAH KIM

"I need a newsletter tool that saves me time, ensures accuracy, and helps me prove the value of our PR efforts"

Age: 29
Job Title: Communications Manager at an art Company
Experience: 5+ years in PR and media relations
Education: Bachelor's in Communications

Sarah manages media monitoring and curates newsletters for stakeholders in a fast-paced environment. Tech-savvy and detail-oriented, she aims to showcase her PR team's impact through timely, well-curated content.

GOALS

Deliver accurate, timely newsletters that showcase positive media coverage and highlight PR impact.

PAIN POINTS

Overwhelming manual workflows, high accuracy pressure, and tight deadlines.

STAGES	STAGE 1	STAGE 2	STAGE 3	STAGE 4	STAGE 5	STAGE 6	STAGE 7	STAGE 8	STAGE 9
GOALS	Create a newsletter	Select a template	Customize template	Select content sources	Add saved search	Select content sources	Email settings	Preview	Schedule
ACTIONS	1. Click create 2. Select create a manual Newsletter	1. Click the template to review 2. Click back and forth to review 3. Start with the template	1. Click a header 2. Update company logo 3. Update the Image 4. Change copy 5. Add more sections 6. Set up content elements	1. Add inputs	1. Create search 2. Adjust filters 3. Save search 4. Back to newsletter step 4	1. Add inputs per section 2. Click next	1. Create template name 2. Add subject for newsletter 3. Select a sender 4. Select recipient list	1. Check desktop and mobile view before scheduling 2. Click schedule if everything looks great	1. Change the date 2. Select a specific time 3. Click schedule
THOUGHTS	"What's the different between automated newsletter and manual newsletter"	"I'm not sure what's different between each template." "Which template would be the best fit for my needs?"	"How can I create a branded template without so much effort?"	1. Why can't I search here? 2. Why didn't you tell me at the beginning?	1. I want to finish this and get back to the newsletter 2. Can I get help with creating search instead?	1. Why does the preview is empty? 2. How can I know which article will be selected? 3. How can I filter out the content I don't want	1. I've already tried so many steps. 2. Where can I preview my newsletter? 3. The recipient list is hard to organize	1. Finally I can preview it 2. How can I receive a test email before send to other people in the team?	1. I hope I can preview before sending 2. Not very confident with the automated newsletter
PAIN POINTS	1. Confusion between automated and manual newsletters 2. Lack of clear guidance on the differences	1. Unclear differences between templates 2. Hard to decide without guidance 3. No context of how templates work with my content	Hard to learn and slow to use — too many manual steps, no quick solutions.	1. Inability to search effectively 2. Lack of upfront guidance on content source setup	1. Time-consuming process with multiple steps 2. Lack of clarity on setting up at the beginning	1. The preview is not real 2. Limited filtering options for unwanted content	1. Too many steps and still can't see the preview 2. The recipient list is not user-friendly for large lists	1. The current preview doesn't reflect the actual final version. 2. Need to see a real test email to feel confident.	1. Too many steps overall 2. Lack of confidence in the reliability of the automated newsletter.
EMOTIONS	Curious	Confused	Frustrated	Annoyed	Impatient	Skeptical	Tired	Satisfy	Relieved
TOUCHPOINTS									
OPPORTUNITIES	1. More clear explanation with visual at the beginning	1. Add a quick comparison guide to help users choose the right template. 2. Auto generate email template based on their branding	1. Simplify the process of adding logos, text, and adjusting section settings. 2. Auto generate customized template based on users' data	1. Notify them at the beginning they need saved search before curating a newsletter 2. Auto generate saved search based on their default data we have	1. Reduce the number of steps required to create and save searches. 2. Integrate help prompts or quick tips for common roadblocks.	1. Offer clear feedback when previews are empty, explaining why content isn't displayed. 2. Provide filters to exclude irrelevant content easily.	1. Streamline email setup with autofill suggestions based on past campaigns. 2. Improve recipient list management with CSV uploads and bulk import options. 3. Add a live email preview feature during setup.	1. Provide a true-to-life preview that matches the final email version. 2. Enable test email sending to multiple recipients for internal reviews.	1. Allow users to preview before final scheduling to ensure confidence. 2. Include a confirmation checklist to verify all steps are complete.

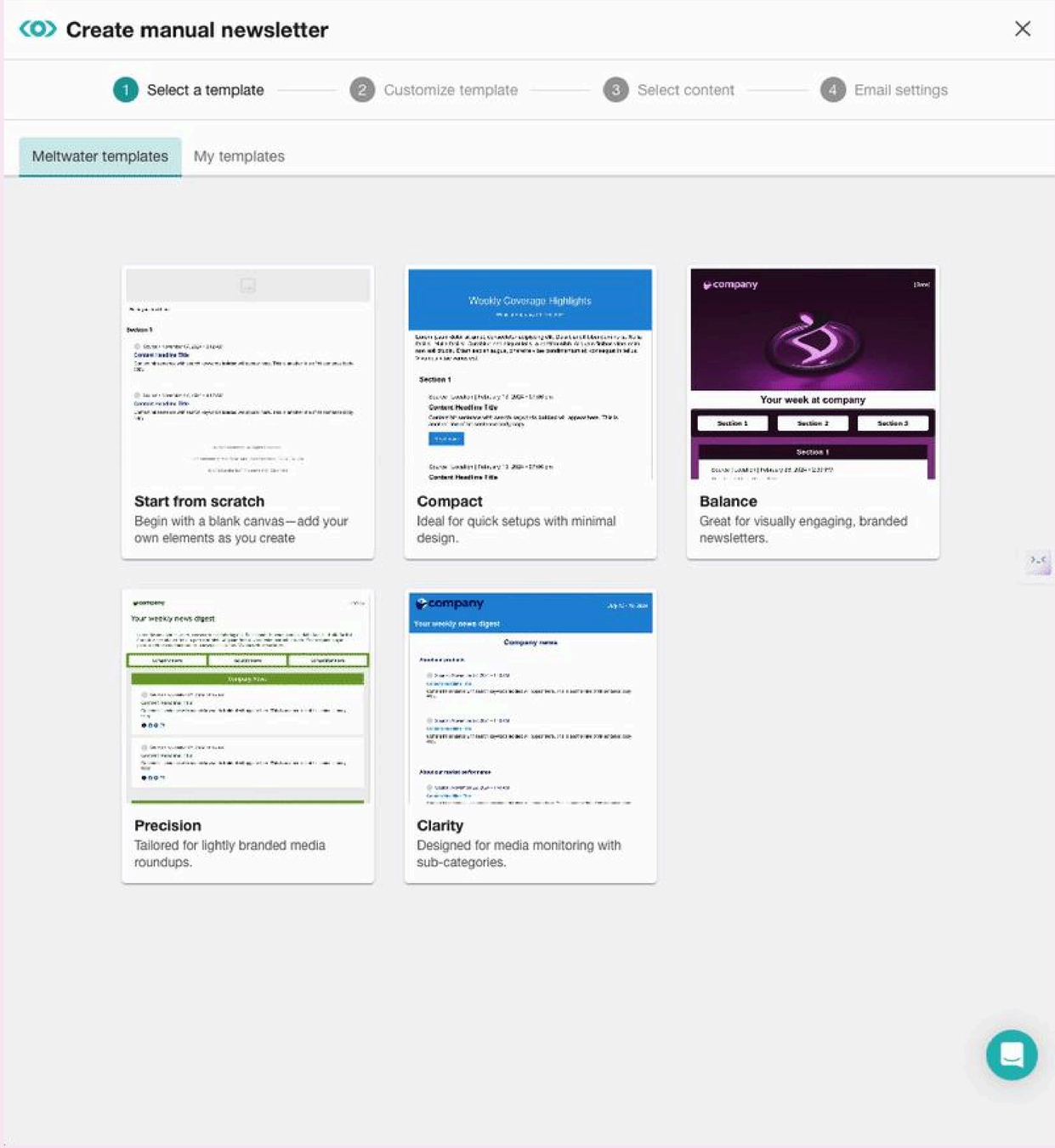
Three main issues

Template Confusion
→ Cognitive overload

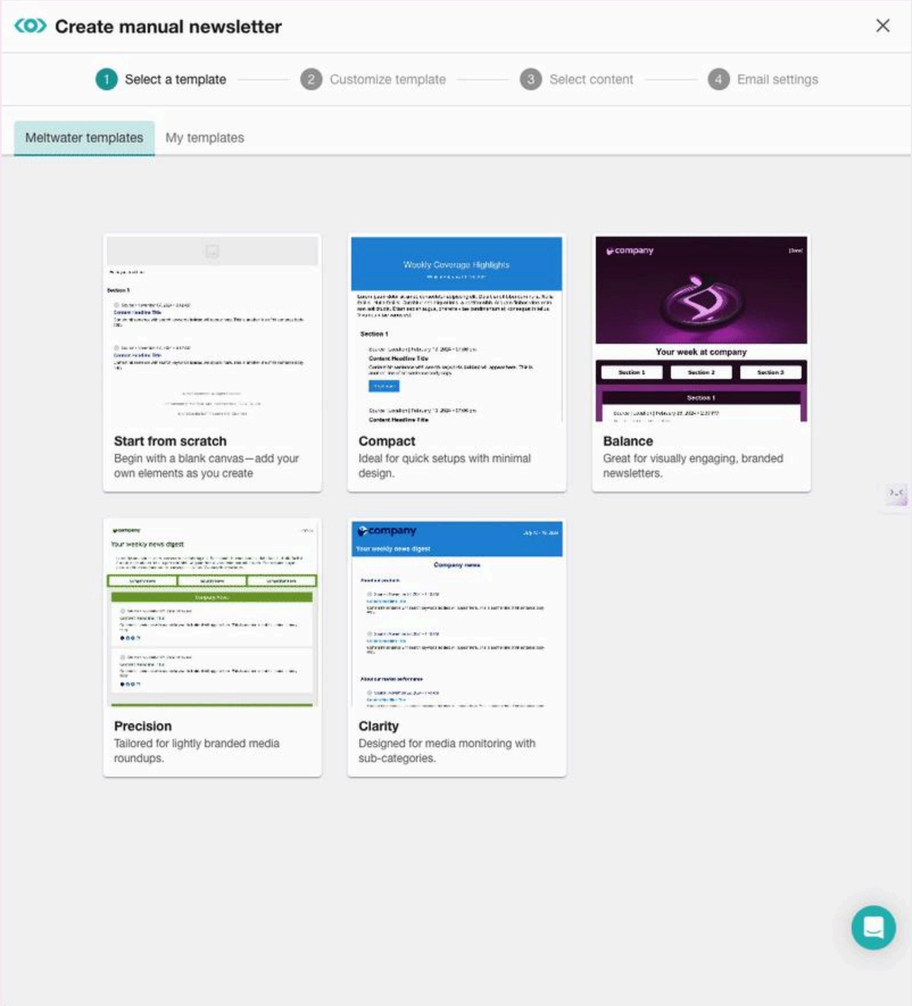
Complex customization
→ Task overload

High manual effort
→ Inefficient process

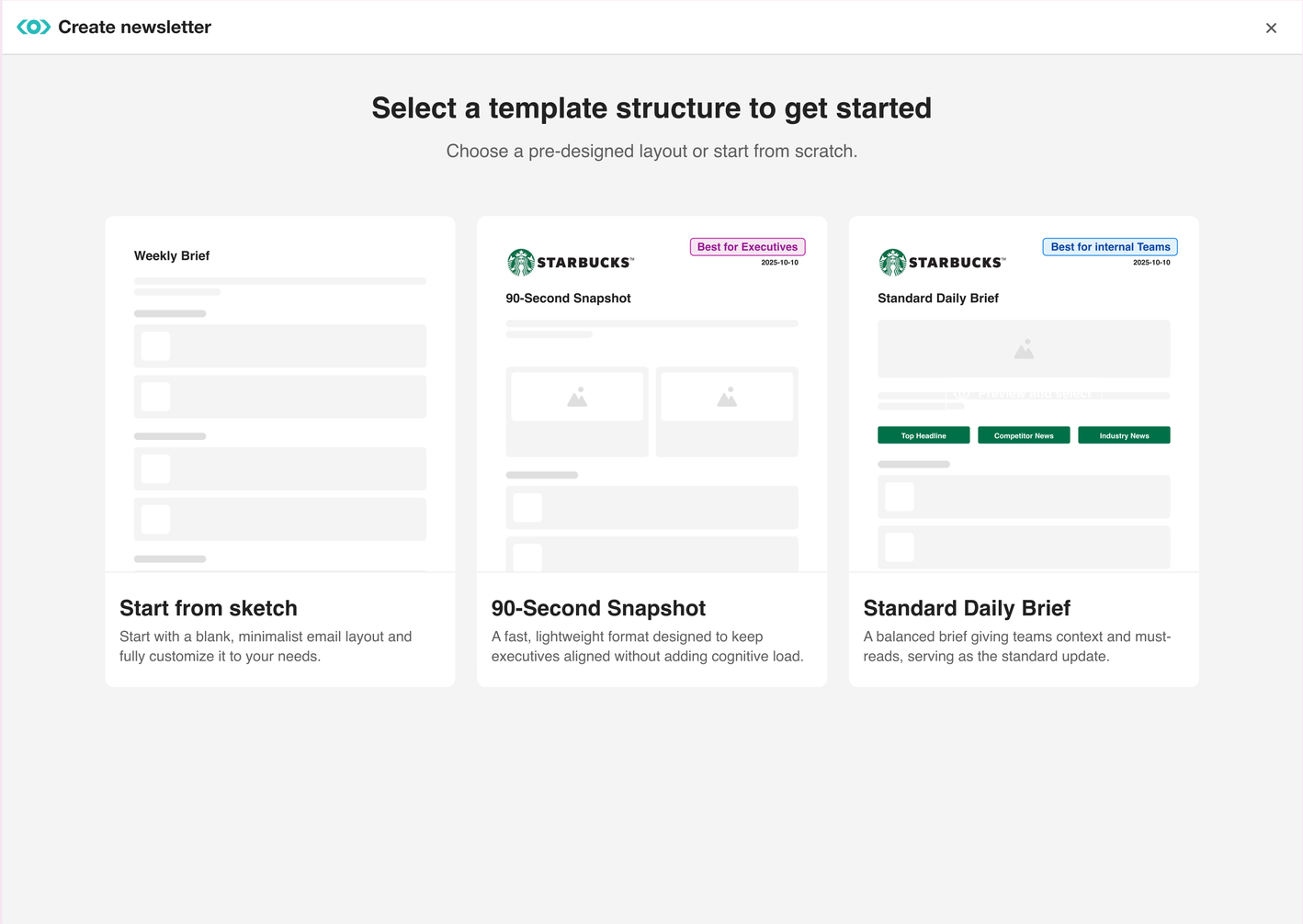
Template Confusion



Current design



New Wireframe

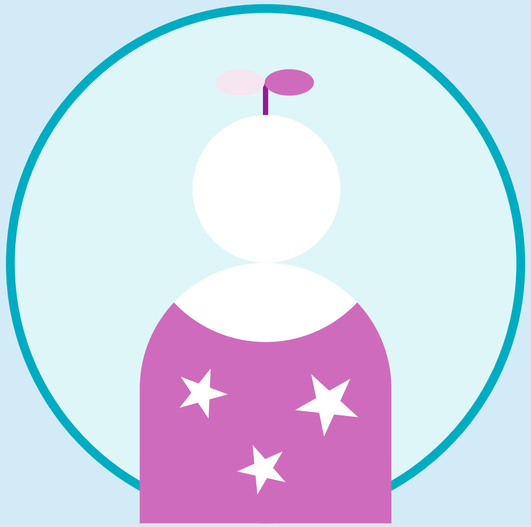


Understand more about meltwater newsletter

“Newsletter” ≠ Newsletter
“Newsletter” = Media monitoring roundup

90-Second Snapshot

Audience: Busy execs
Style: Ultra-short, scannable (<2 min).
Contents: Summary(top item + risk), Must-Know (brand, competitor, industry), Metrics.
Use Case: Daily quick pulse



Standard Daily Brief

Audience: Comms, marketing, leaders
Style: Compact with context
Contents: Top line, Must-reads (brand/ competitor/industry/social), Metrics.
Use Case: Default daily/weekly brief

Crisis / Issue Brief

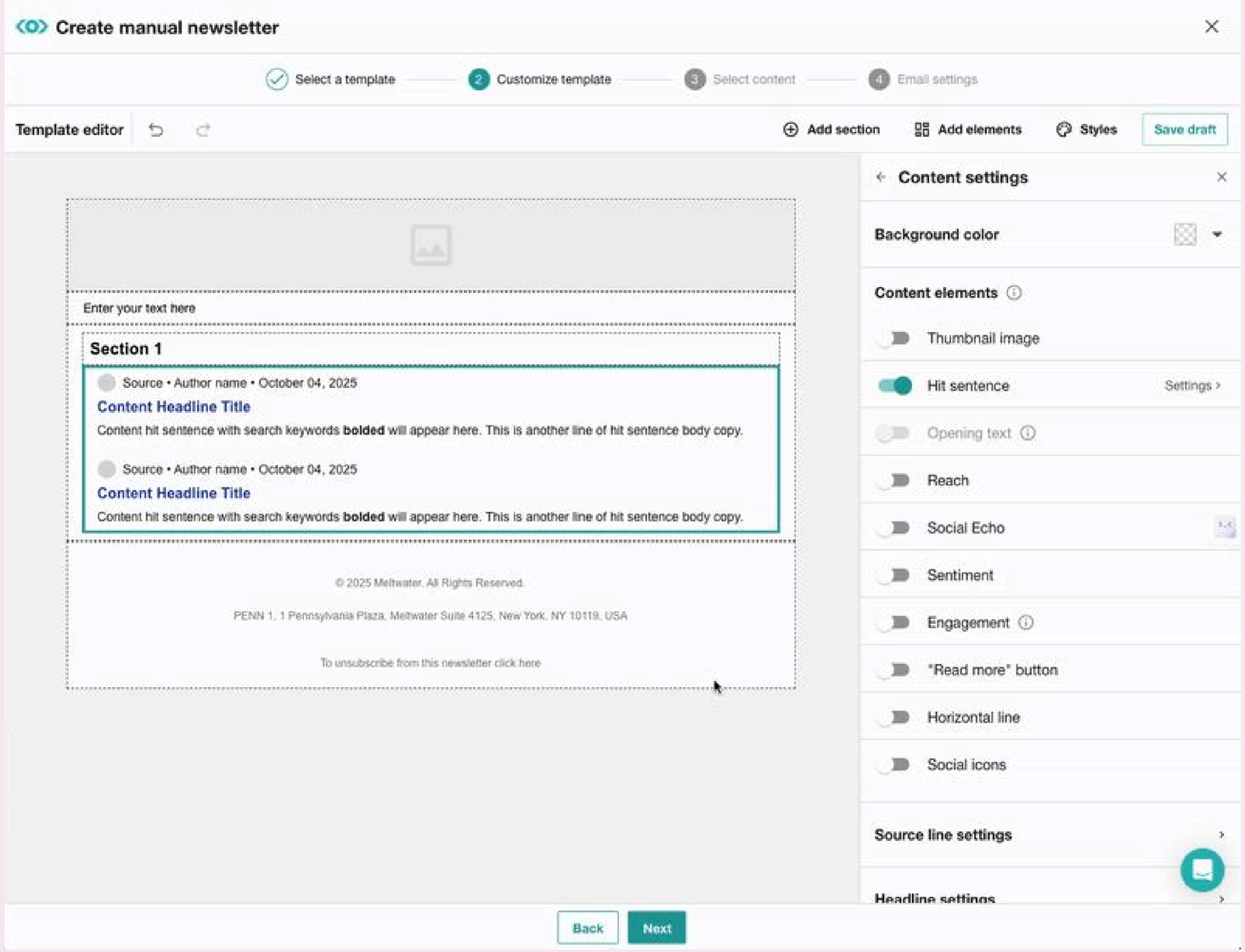
Audience: Crisis teams, execs, PR/legal
Style: Narrow, urgent, issue-focused.
Contents: What happened, position, actions, coverage, metrics
Use Case: Real-time incident response

Q&A

Use this space to tee up some questions from the audience.

THANK YOU!

Complex customization



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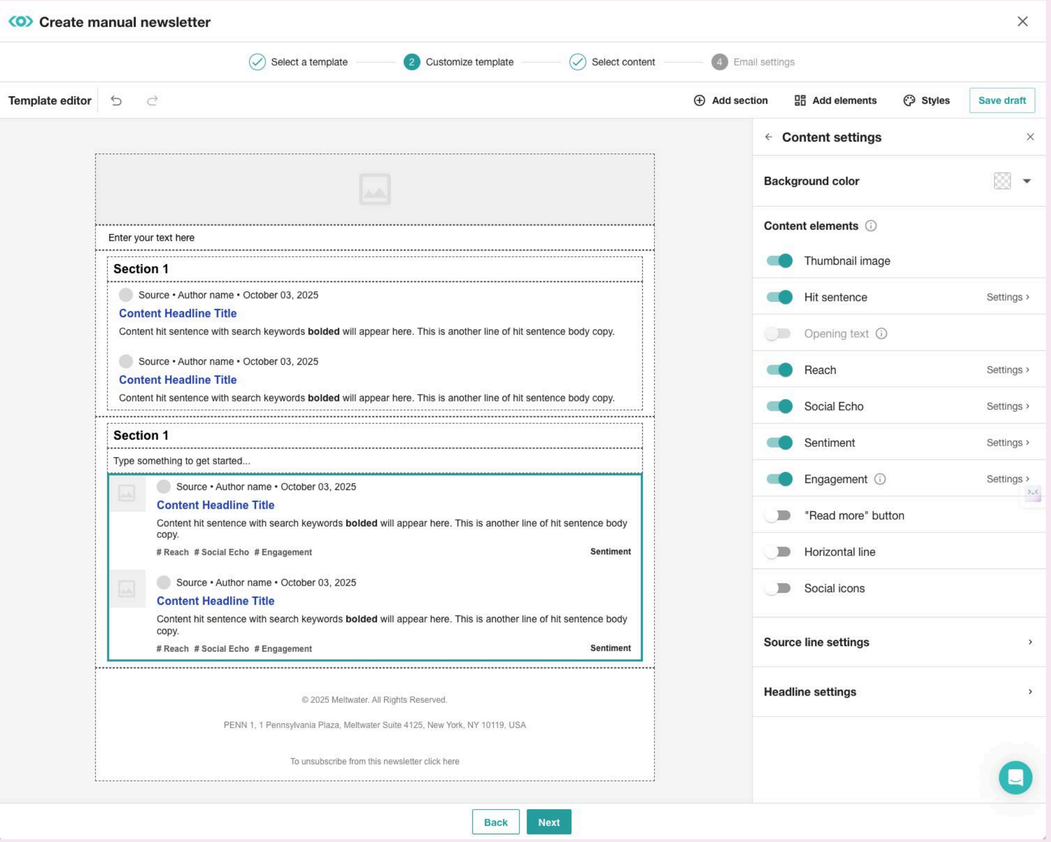

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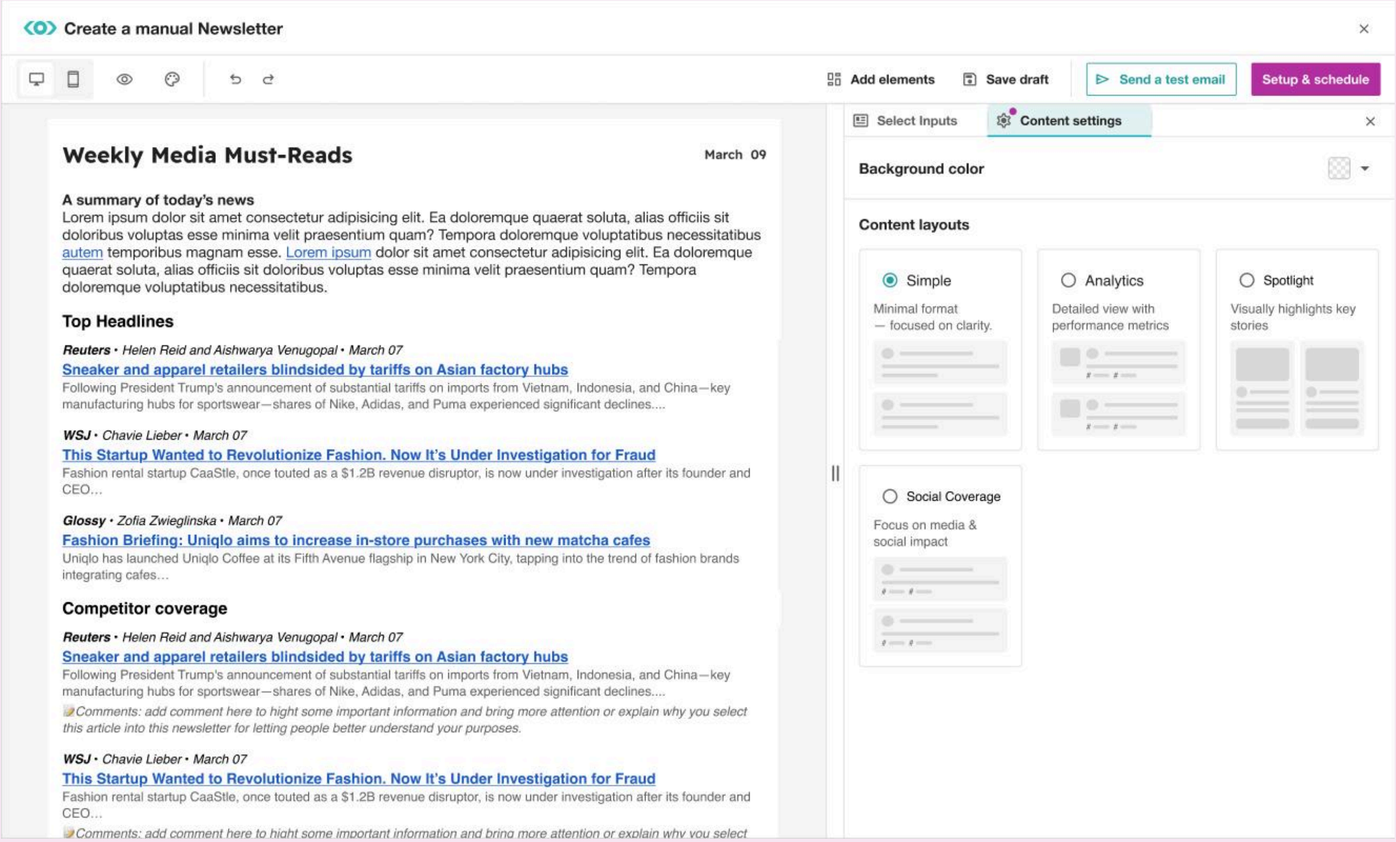
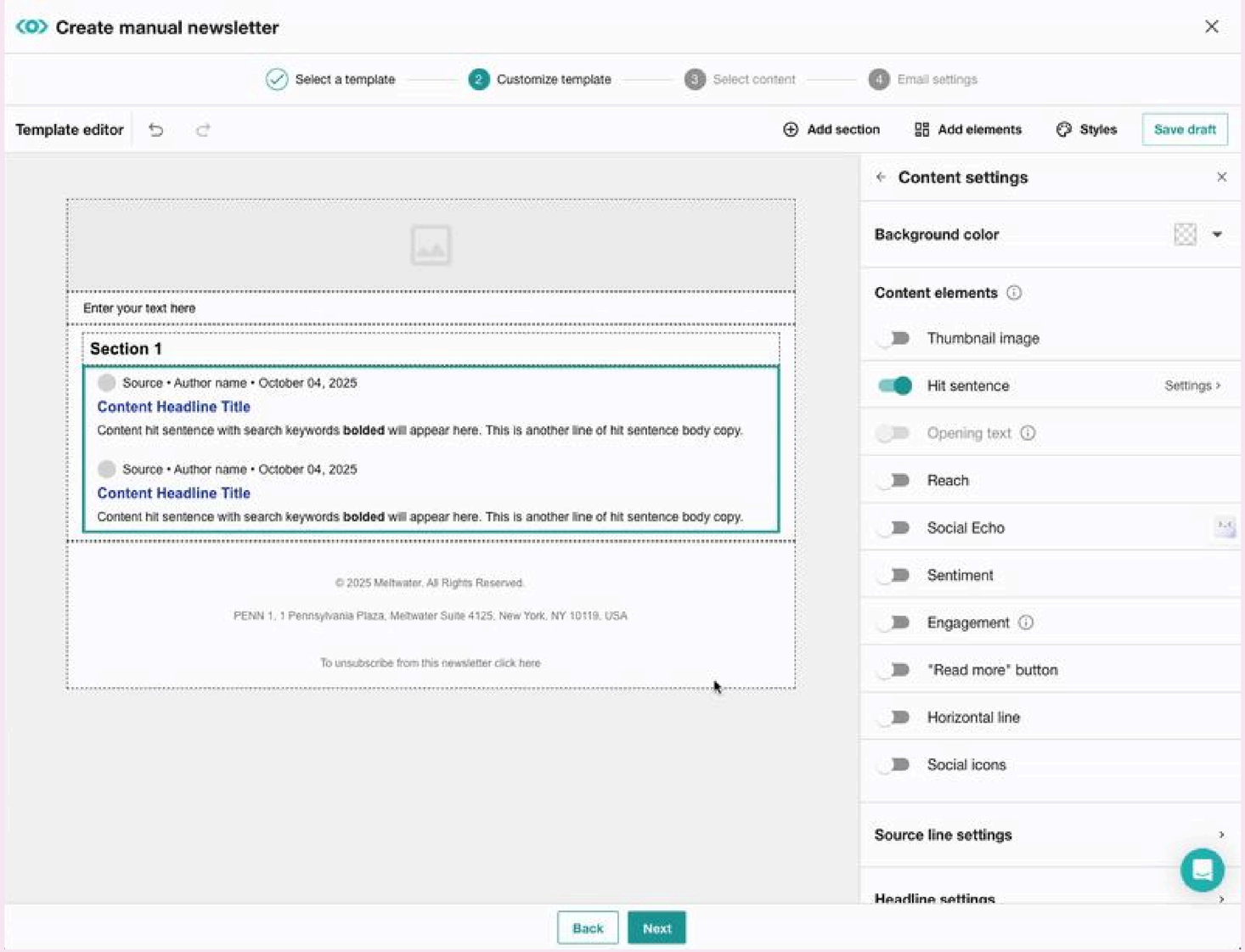


High manual effort



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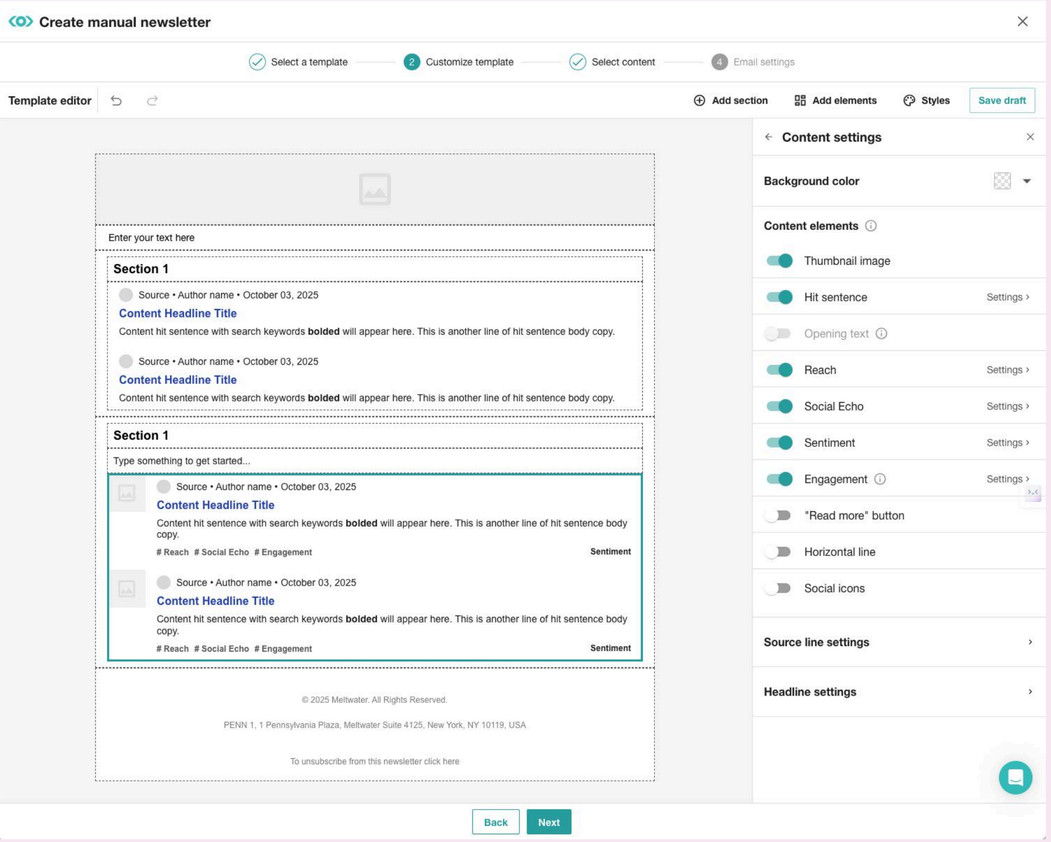
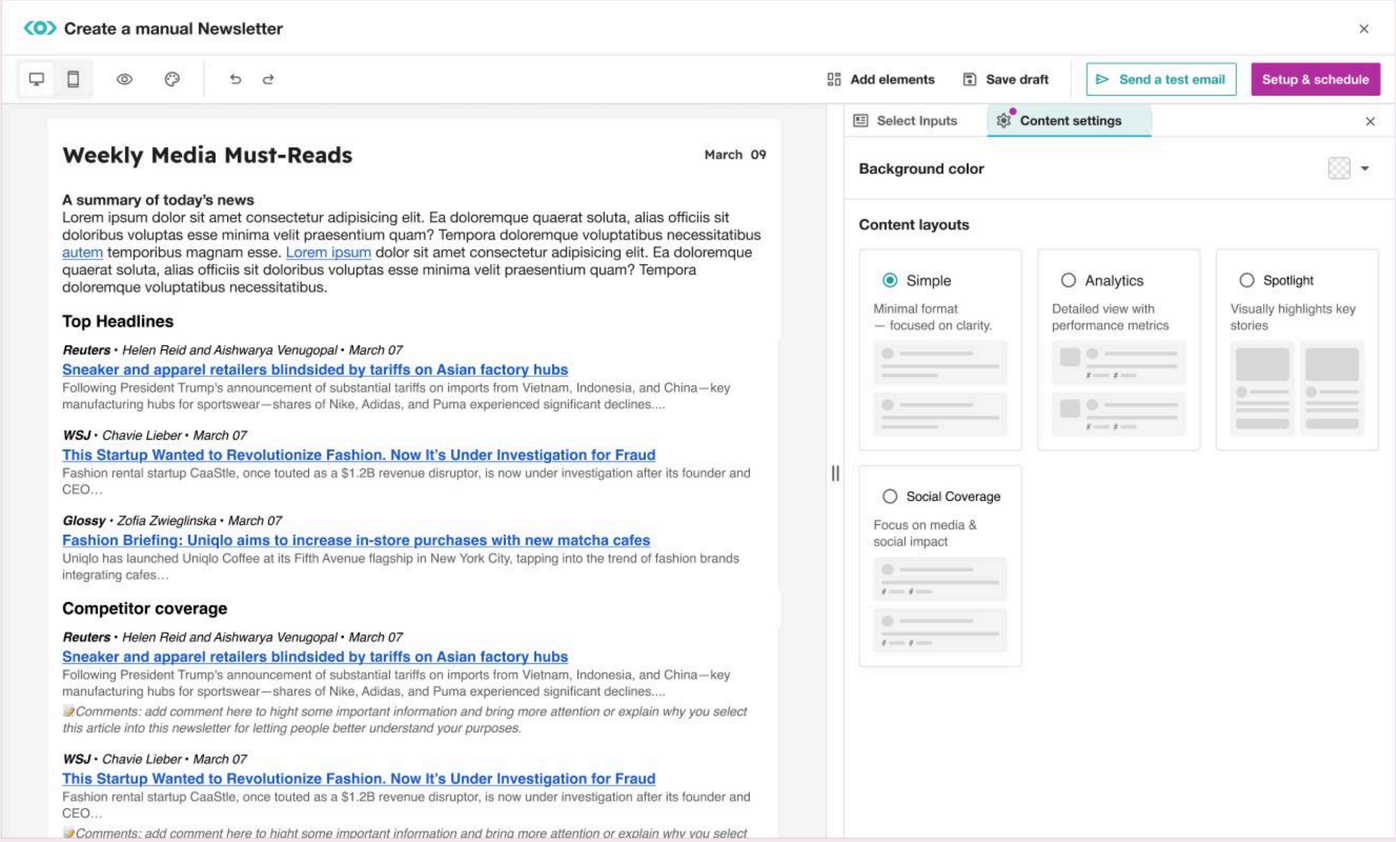
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